

V. ANANTHA NAGESWARAN, Chief Economic Advisor (CEA), says that boosting domestic income generation, as well as production, are the only ways to combat trade restrictions. The Economic Survey 2024-25, presented in the Parliament on January 31, made a case for reducing the regulatory burden. The pitch found an echo in the Union Budget a day later. Donald Trump's re-election as the 47th US President was followed by a series of levies and tariffs on other countries. He imposed 25% tariffs on imports from Mexico and Canada, and an additional 10% on China. He has also said the US would impose 100% tariffs on BRICS nations, including India, if they move to replace the US dollar in global transactions. In the backdrop of an increasingly unstable global order, the CEA explains how India could safeguard its interests, in an interaction with *Business Today*, conducted a day before the Budget. Edited excerpts:



The big message resonating from the Survey was the call for deregulation in India. We had flagged it already in the Survey that we brought out in July 2024. This Survey takes it to the next level by exploring

specific dimensions in different sectors.

We are not following the global template or global debate, we are simply talking about what is necessary for India, which is something that we have flagged even earlier. Which specific actions will follow because of this is of course, not just up to the Union government alone, but as the Survey makes it clear, much of the action must be in the domain of state governments as well.

But nonetheless, I think the actions that need to follow rest with

the government agencies across the country. It will be difficult for me to speculate on how these actions will happen and who will take the lead, because some states are already doing that.

The Union government has done a lot in the last 10 years on the issue of ease of doing business. They came up with the Jan Vishwas Act 1.0. There is a lot of talk about the next Jan Vishwas scheme as well. It is an ongoing exercise in many states.

Some states are more advanced than others,

but the Survey wants to spur some action in areas where there is potential for economic activity to respond more than in some other areas.

We also want to catalyse the discussion in that direction.



There is also a significant mention about 8% growth rate that is required for 'Viksit Bharat'. With whatever the states and Centre may choose to do about deregulation, is there any correlation that can be drawn

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